

In ancient India, Nalanda was a famous centre of Buddhist learning and University as well. It was located at Rajgir (at present Rajgriha) in southern Bihar. Nalanda University came into existence during the period of Guptas. By the end of the twelfth century, Mahavihara waned due to Muslim invasion. The importance of Nalanda started declining due to the Pala rulers of Bengal as they started giving protection to Vikramshila University. Hence, both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are correct, and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).

26. 'Nav Nalanda Mahavihar' is famous for –

- (a) Hsuan-Tsang memorial
- (b) Birth place of Mahavir
- (c) Pali Research Centre
- (d) Museum

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

In 1951, the Nav Nalanda Mahavihar, a modern-day research center for Pali and Buddhism, was founded by the government of Bihar near the ruins of ancient Nalanda.

27. Which one of the following is not common between Buddhism and Jainism?

- (a) Ahimsa
- (b) Indifference to Vedas
- (c) Self-mortification
- (d) Rejection of Rituals

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

Avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment and choosing a middle path between them was a trait of Buddhism while extreme penance leading to self-mortification was a trait of Jainism.

28. The painting of 'Bodhisattva Padmapani' is located at

- (a) Bagh
- (b) Ellora
- (c) Ajanta
- (d) Badami

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

The painting of Bodhisattva Padmapani is one of the most famous art structure in the cave I of Ajanta. Padmapani in Sanskrit literally translates into "one who holds the lotus." The Bodhisattva Padmapani sits among a crowd of devotees, both princesses and commoners with long, dark hair hanging down below a jewelled crown, he stands holding his attribute, a blue lotus flower in his right hand.

Jain Religion

1. Where was Mahavira Swami born?

- (a) Kundagram
- (b) Pataliputra
- (c) Magadha
- (d) Vaishali

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Mahavira Swami was born in Kundagram (Kundalpur) near Vaishali in 599 B.C. His mother Trishala was the sister of Chetak, the king of Lichchhavi Republic, and his father Siddhartha was the head of Gyatrik Kshatriya. Nandivardhan was his elder brother.

2. Mahavira Jain breathed his last at –

- (a) Rajgir
- (b) Ranchi
- (c) Pavapuri
- (d) Samastipur

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Mahavira Swami was born in Kundagram near Vaishali in 599 B.C. He attained Nirvana at the age of (approx) 72 years in 527 B.C. in Pavapuri, located near Rajgriha (Rajgir).

3. The salvation place of Mahavirji, the originator of Jain religion, is located at :-

- (a) Maner
- (b) Rajgir
- (c) Pavapuri
- (d) Jalan Port
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Triratna or Three Jewels, i.e., right knowledge, right faith and right action are related to which of the following?

- (a) Buddhism
- (b) Hinduism
- (c) Jainism
- (d) Christianity
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (c)

Three means are said to be important for 'Moksha' in Jain philosophy: Right faith, Right action (conduct) and Right knowledge. These are known as 'Triratna' in Jain religion. Freedom from the bondage and effect of evil omens is called Sanvar Tattva to make the spirit free from the bondage of all. The destruction of Karma is the Nirjara element.